

Module 2

IEEE 1364-2001 (Verilog-2001)

Learning objectives

- Master the major Verilog update (IEEE 1364-2001) and its additions over 1364-1995: ANSI ports, impl...

Prerequisites

- See module README

Learning path

Learning Path

Diagram: Learning Path

(render with mmdc when available)

flowchart LR

T1["IEEE 1364-2001 Context"]

T2["ANSI-Style Port Declarations"]

T1 --> T2

T3["Implicit Sensitivity: always"]

T2 --> T3

Master the major Verilog update (IEEE 1364-2001) and its additions over 1364-1995: ANSI ports, implicit sensitivity, generate, signed types...

Overview

- This module covers IEEE Std 1364-2001 (Verilog-2001), the first major revision of the Verilog stand...

How to learn this module

Suggested learning path (1/2)

- Skim this document — Goal, Overview, and Topics
Covered set the IEEE scope for Module 2.
- Study design architecture — See how DUTs, examples, and testbenches fit together under ``module2/``.
- Work through labs in order — Open ``module2/EXAMPLES.md`` and run each ``make clean && make run`` from...
- Run the full module script — ``./scripts/module2.sh`` from the repo root to simulate all examples and...
- Complete the exercises — Try each exercise in this document before reading solutions or peeking at...

Suggested learning path (2/2)

- Review Common Pitfalls — Can you explain each mistake and the fix?
- Self-check — Use ``module2/CHECKLIST.md`` before starting the next module.

Syllabus topics

1. IEEE 1364-2001 Context (1/2)

- ANSI-style port declarations: Direction and type (and size) in the port list
- `**`always @*`**`: Implicit sensitivity for combinational logic (no manual list)
- `generate`: Conditional and loop-based instantiation and logic
- `signed`: Signed arithmetic and signed nets/variables
- Multi-dimensional arrays: e.g. ``reg [7:0] mem [0:255]``
- `localparam`: Named constants that cannot be overridden

1. IEEE 1364-2001 Context (2/2)

- ANSI-style task/function: Input/output in the header
- Other: File I/O improvements, ``$signed``/``$unsigned``, attribute syntax, etc.
- No SystemVerilog: no ``logic``, ``always_comb``/``always_ff``, interfaces, packages, classes
- No type parameters or interfaces (those are 1800)

2. ANSI-Style Port Declarations (2001)

- input wire: Default for input; can omit ``wire`` (e.g. ``input [7:0] a``).
- output reg: Required when the output is driven in ``always``/``initial``.
- output wire: When the output is driven only by ``assign`` or submodule.
- Same behavior; 2001 is more concise and keeps port and type in one place.

3. Implicit Sensitivity: always @* (2001)

- `**`@*`` (or ``@(*)`**`): Sensitive to every signal read in the block (RHS and conditions).
- Use for combinational logic only; do not use for sequential (use ``always @(posedge clk)``).
- `**Prefer `@*`**`: For combinational blocks; fewer errors, easier to maintain.
- Explicit list: When targeting strict 1995 compatibility or when a tool does not support ``@*``.

4. Generate (2001)

- genvar: Loop variable for generate loops; not a runtime variable.
- generate for: Replicates logic/instances; index must be constant at elaboration.
- generate if / else: Choose one of several implementations at elaboration.

5. Signed Types (2001)

- signed: Affects arithmetic and comparison in expressions involving that net/reg.
- Unsigned (default): No sign extension; values 0 to 2^N-1 .

6. Multi-Dimensional Arrays (2001)

- Packed (left): ``[7:0]`` — contiguous bits, can be used as a single vector.
- Unpacked (right): ``[0:255]`` — array of elements; select with one index at a time in 2001.

7. localparam (2001)

- parameter: Can be overridden: ``#(.WIDTH(16))``.
- localparam: Cannot be overridden; often derived from parameters or fixed.

8. ANSI-Style Tasks and Functions (2001)

- automatic: Optional; gives automatic storage (re-entrant). Useful for recursive or concurrent calls.
- input/output in header: Cleaner than 1995 style; avoids duplicate declarations.
- Note: In 1364-2001 use ``output reg`` (not ``output logic``; ``logic`` is SystemVerilog).

Hands-on examples

Module 2 toolchain check

```
$ command -v iverilog >/dev/null && echo "Toolchain ready: $(iverilog  
-V 2>&1 | head -1)"
```

Terminal: module2_check

Toolchain ready: Icarus Verilog version 12.0 (stable) ()

Example 1: ANSI Ports

- Module and instantiation with ANSI-style ports
- Port direction and type in port list

Demo: ANSI Ports

```
$ cd module2/examples/ansi_ports && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex01_ansi_ports

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top mux2.v
vvp top
ANSI ports (1364-2001): direction and type in port list
sel a b | y
0 0 0 | 0
0 0 1 | 0
0 1 0 | 1
0 1 1 | 1
1 0 0 | 0
1 0 1 | 1
1 1 0 | 0
1 1 1 | 1
mux2.v:34: $finish called at 80 (1s)
```

Example 2: always @*

- Combinational blocks with implicit sensitivity
- No manual sensitivity list; tool infers from RHS

Demo: always @*

```
$ cd module2/examples/procedural && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex02_procedural

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top always_star.v
vvp top
always @* (1364-2001): implicit sensitivity
a b c sel | y_comb mux_out
0 0 0 0 | 0 0
1 1 0 0 | 1 1
0 1 0 1 | 0 1
always_star.v:37: $finish called at 30 (1s)
```


Example 3: Generate

- Parameterized mux; generate-style parameterization
- genvar, elaboration-time logic

Demo: Generate

```
$ cd module2/examples/generate && make clean && make run
```

```
Terminal: ex03_generate  
rm -f top  
iverilog -o top param_mux.v  
vvp top  
Generate (1364-2001): parameterized mux  
  sel=0 a=1010 b=0101 y=1010  
  sel=1 a=1010 b=0101 y=0101  
param_mux.v:43: $finish called at 20 (1s)
```

Example 4: Generate if/else

- Conditional implementation by parameter (e.g. USE_CLIP wrap vs saturate)
- generate if/else at elaboration

Demo: Generate if/else

```
$ cd module2/examples/generate_if && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex04_generate_if

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top gen_if.v
vvp top
generate if/else (1364-2001): USE_CLIP selects implementation
  a=10 b= 5 wrap=15 clip=15
  a=12 b= 8 wrap= 4 clip=15
gen_if.v:34: $finish called at 20 (1s)
```

Example 5: Generate Ripple Adder

- N-bit ripple-carry adder using generate for (full_adder instances)
- genvar loop, replicated hierarchy

Demo: Generate Ripple Adder

```
$ cd module2/examples/generate_ripple_adder && make clean && make run
```

```
Terminal: ex05_generate_ripple_adder  
rm -f top  
iverilog -o top ripple_adder.v  
vvp top  
generate for: N-bit ripple-carry adder (1364-2001)  
  3 + 5 + 0 = 8 cout=0  
 15 + 1 + 0 = 0 cout=1  
 7 + 7 + 1 = 15 cout=0  
ripple_adder.v:55: $finish called at 30 (1s)
```

Example 6: Signed

- signed reg/wire, \$signed/\$unsigned
- Two's complement arithmetic in RTL

Demo: Signed

```
$ cd module2/examples/signed && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex06_signed

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top adder_signed.v
vvp top
Signed (1364-2001): signed reg/wire, $signed/$unsigned
  a= 50 b= 30 sum_signed= 80 sum_unsigned= 80
  a= -10 b= 20 sum_signed= 10 sum_unsigned=266
  a=-100 b= -30 sum_signed=-130 sum_unsigned=382
adder_signed.v:28: $finish called at 30 (1s)
```


Example 7: Signed vs Unsigned Comparison

- `$signed()` in expressions; `a < b unsigned` vs `signed`
- Cast in expressions without changing declaration

Demo: Signed vs Unsigned Comparison

```
$ cd module2/examples/signed_compare && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex07_signed_compare

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top signed_compare.v
vvp top
Signed vs unsigned comparison (1364-2001): $signed() in expressions
  a=200 b= 50  lt_unsigned=0 lt_signed=1
  a=0xf0 b= 10  lt_unsigned=0 lt_signed=1
signed_compare.v:28: $finish called at 20 (1s)
```

Example 8: Decoder

- 2:4 decoder with ANSI ports and always @* (case)
- Combinational case; one-hot output

Demo: Decoder

```
$ cd module2/examples/decoder && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex08_decoder

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top decoder.v
vvp top
Decoder 2:4 (1364-2001): ANSI ports, always @*
sel | y
0 | 0001
1 | 0010
2 | 0100
3 | 1000
decoder.v:33: $finish called at 40 (1s)
```

Example 9: Multi-Dimensional Arrays

- Memory-style arrays (`reg [7:0] mem [0:255]`), indexing
- Packed vs unpacked; array indexing rules in 2001

Demo: Multi-Dimensional Arrays

```
$ cd module2/examples/arrays && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex09_arrays

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top ram_simple.v
vvp top
Multi-dimensional arrays (1364-2001): reg [7:0] mem [0:255]
  addr=10 dout=a5
  addr=20 dout=b2
ram_simple.v:54: $finish called at 86 (1s)
```

Example 10: Multi-Dim Style

- 2x4 buffer using 1D array indexed as $\text{row} * 4 + \text{col}$
- Emulating 2D with 1D array; index expression

Demo: Multi-Dim Style

```
$ cd module2/examples/multi_dim_arrays && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex10_multi_dim_arrays

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top multi_dim.v
vvp top
Multi-dimensional style (1364-2001): buf[row*4+col] for 2x4
[0][1]=a1
[1][2]=b2
multi_dim.v:59: $finish called at 86 (1s)
```


Example 11: Parameters and localparam

- Parameter override, localparam for derived constants
- When to use parameter vs localparam

Demo: Parameters and localparam

```
$ cd module2/examples/parameters && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex11_parameters

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top counter_param.v
vvp top
parameter and localparam (1364-2001): WIDTH=4, MAX=15
count= 0
count= 1
count= 2
count= 3
count= 4
count= 5
count= 6
count= 7
count= 8
count= 9
count=10
count=11
count=12
count=13
count=14
count=15
count= 0
count= 1
count= 2
count= 3
counter_param.v:37: $finish called at 235 (1s)
```

Example 12: ANSI Task/Function

- Input/output in header, automatic functions
- 2001 style vs 1995 style

Demo: ANSI Task/Function

```
$ cd module2/examples/tasks_functions && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex12_tasks_functions

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top ansi_task_func.v
vvp top
ANSI task/function (1364-2001): input/output in header
  x= 10 y= 20 add8= 30 prod(low8)=200
  x=  5 y=  6 add8= 11 prod(low8)= 30
ansi_task_func.v:38: $finish called at 20 (1s)
```

Example 13: ANSI Task with Output

- task automatic apply_reset(output reg rn); begin/end
body
- Task with output argument; testbench reset pattern

Demo: ANSI Task with Output

```
$ cd module2/examples/task_ansi && make clean && make run
```

Terminal: ex13_task_ansi

```
rm -f top
iverilog -o top task_ansi.v
vvp top
ANSI task with output (1364-2001): task apply_reset(output reg rn)
t=125 rst_n=1 count= x
t=135 rst_n=1 count= x
t=145 rst_n=1 count= x
t=155 rst_n=1 count= x
t=165 rst_n=1 count= x
task_ansi.v:33: $finish called at 165 (1s)
```

Common pitfalls

Using always @* for Sequential Logic

- Mistake: ``always @* q <= d;`` intending a flip-flop.
- Reality: ``@*`` is for combinational logic; it does not create a clock edge.
- Correct: Use ``always @(posedge clk)`` (and ``<=```) for sequential logic.
- Why: Mixing the two causes simulation/synthesis mismatches and unintended latches.

genvar in Normal Code

- Mistake: Using genvar in an always block or initial block.
- Reality: genvar is only for generate loops; it does not exist at runtime.
- Correct: Use integer or reg for runtime loops; use genvar only inside generate for.
- Why: genvar is elaborated away; it is not a simulation variable.

Overriding localparam

- Mistake: Trying to override localparam at instantiation (e.g. ``#(.MAX(100))``).
- Reality: localparam cannot be overridden.
- Correct: Use parameter for values that must be overridden; use localparam for fixed or derived cons...
- Why: The standard does not allow localparam in the parameter list.

Signed vs Unsigned Mix

- Mistake: Mixing signed and unsigned in one expression without `$signed/$unsigned` and expecting a par...
- Reality: Rules for sign extension and comparison depend on operands.
- Correct: Be explicit: use signed types or `$signed/$unsigned` and verify with testbenches.
- Why: Implicit mixing leads to wrong arithmetic and comparison results.

Generate Block Scope

- Mistake: Referencing generate block names or genvar at runtime.
- Reality: Generate blocks are elaborated at compile time; names are for hierarchy.
- Correct: Use generate for structure; use normal variables and blocks for runtime behavior.
- Why: Generate is not “runtime”; it only affects what gets instantiated.

Practice & assessment

What you should know (1/2)

- ✓ Write modules with ANSI-style port declarations (1364-2001)
- ✓ Use ``always @*`` for combinational logic and avoid sensitivity-list errors
- ✓ Use generate (for, if/else) for parameterized and conditional RTL
- ✓ Use signed types and `$signed/$unsigned` for signed arithmetic
- ✓ Declare and use multi-dimensional arrays (e.g. memories)
- ✓ Use `localparam` for constants that must not be overridden

What you should know (2/2)

- ✓ Write ANSI-style tasks and functions
- ✓ Compare 1364-1995 and 1364-2001 and list what 2001 adds

Exercises

- ANSI Ports
- always @
- Generate
- Signed
- Arrays and localparam

Exercises

- Using always @* for Sequential Logic
- genvar in Normal Code
- Overriding localparam
- Signed vs Unsigned Mix
- Generate Block Scope

Summary & next steps

- Master the major Verilog update (IEEE 1364-2001) and its additions over 1364-1995: ANSI ports, impl...
- Complete module2/CHECKLIST.md
- Review module2/EXAMPLES.md and run each lab
- Next: Next module in course